

DECENTRALIZED UNDERWRITING GROUP

Industry Partnership Outreach Framework

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The Opportunity

Insurance education and certification organizations — The Institutes, The National Alliance, IEA, PLUS, and RIMS — face a shared structural problem: their designees get credentialed and vanish into carrier jobs. There is no surface where those credentials live publicly, no place for practicing underwriters to demonstrate ongoing competence, and no employer-agnostic path to consulting income.

DUG is that surface. This framework outlines how to approach each organization as a partner — not a competitor — and what a mutually beneficial relationship looks like.

Priority & Partnership Overview

Organization	Best First Move
The Institutes (CPCU, AU)	Credential verification API + AU graduate pipeline
The National Alliance (CIC, CISR)	Seminar co-sponsorship + CE credit pathway
IEA (Insurance Education Association)	CE provider approval — highest near-term leverage
PLUS (Professional Liability U/W Society)	Dojo contest sponsorship + annual conference presence
RIMS	Member benefit pitch — DUG as pre-renewal advisory resource

Priority Initiative: CE Provider Approval

If DUG Dojo completions count toward continuing education credit hours in even one state, the value proposition for licensed underwriters, agents, and brokers changes fundamentally. IEA (California) is the fastest path to approval. The National Alliance has existing CE-approved programs and could co-sponsor DUG's application in additional states.

Pursuing this in parallel with all other outreach is recommended — it makes every other partner conversation easier.

Partner-by-Partner Outreach Plans

The Institutes — CPCU, AU, ARM, AINS

Credential verification + AU graduate pipeline. The biggest brand in insurance education.

Target audience: CPCU holders, AU (Associate in Underwriting) designees, ARM holders

Outreach priority: 1 — Approach first. Highest credibility impact.

Partnership model: Credential verification data-sharing agreement + graduate co-marketing

What DUG offers them

- **Visibility** Every verified Institutes designation is badged and prominently displayed on DUG member profiles — driving ongoing engagement with their brand post-designation.
- **Outcomes data** DUG can share anonymized Dojo performance data showing how designees perform vs. non-designees — useful research for The Institutes' advocacy work.
- **Referral traffic** DUG profile completion prompts users without designations to explore AU, ARM, and AINS pathways, driving enrollment upstream.
- **CE pathway** Co-sponsor DUG's CE provider application — Dojo completions credited as continuing education hours for Institutes designees.

What DUG asks for

- **Verification access** A formal agreement to query Institutes designation records by license/member number — so DUG's 'CPCU verified' badge carries institutional weight.
- **Co-marketing** One email or newsletter feature per quarter to Institutes alumni promoting DUG as a place to use their credentials.
- **CE sponsorship** Support for DUG's CE provider application in 2–3 anchor states.

Initial outreach email

Subject: Partnership inquiry — credential verification + CE credit pathway for Institutes designees

Hi [Name],

I'm reaching out from DUG — Decentralized Underwriting Group — a platform where credentialed underwriters find independent consulting work, practice complex cases, and build a public reputation that travels with them.

We have a straightforward problem that I think you can help us solve: when a DUG member claims a CPCU or AU designation, we want that badge to mean something verifiable – not just self-reported. A formal data-sharing agreement with The Institutes would make our verification layer credible from day one.

In return, every verified Institutes designation on DUG is a live endorsement of the value of your designations to the practicing market. We're also exploring CE credit approval for Dojo case completions – and would welcome your support as a co-sponsor in that process.

Would you have 30 minutes in the next two weeks to explore what this could look like?

[Your name]
DUG | hello@dug.community

The National Alliance — CIC, CISR, CRM, CRIS

Seminar co-sponsorship + CE credit pathway. The best event network in the business.

Target audience: CIC and CISR holders — heavy on agents, brokers, and commercial lines underwriters

Outreach priority: 2 — Approach concurrently. Events are the fastest activation.

Partnership model: Seminar co-sponsorship + CE provider co-application

What DUG offers them

- **Fresh content** DUG runs a 'Dojo live' session at National Alliance city seminars — a real risk case worked by the room together. Novel content that gets remembered.
- **Revenue share** DUG co-sponsors seminar tracks or breakout sessions, providing sponsorship fees that offset event costs.
- **Member pipeline** CIC/CISR holders are prime candidates for DUG's professional tier marketplace — DUG drives their members toward paid consulting opportunities.
- **CE content** If DUG achieves CE provider status, National Alliance members get an approved way to earn hours through Dojo case completions.

What DUG asks for

- **Event access** Participation as a featured partner at 2–3 regional seminars in year one.
- **Member communication** One featured mention in the National Alliance member newsletter or email per quarter.
- **CE co-sponsorship** Support for DUG's CE provider application in states where National Alliance has existing approved programs.

Initial outreach email

Subject: Seminar partnership inquiry — DUG + National Alliance

Hi [Name],

I'm reaching out from DUG — Decentralized Underwriting Group. We're building the platform where credentialed underwriters practice complex cases, earn consulting income, and build a professional reputation outside of their carrier seat.

Your seminar network is unmatched. We'd like to bring something fresh to those rooms:
a live Dojo session where the audience works a real risk case together, sees how

different people approach the same submission, and walks away with a tangible skill rep.

We're also exploring CE credit approval for Dojo completions. Given your existing approved programs, your support as a co-sponsor in that process would be significant.

Could we get 30 minutes to talk through what a pilot event partnership might look like?

[Your name]

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IEA — Insurance Education Association

CE provider approval. The fastest path to credit hours in California.

Target audience: California-licensed agents, brokers, and underwriters requiring CE hours

Outreach priority: 1 — Approach first, in parallel with The Institutes. CE approval changes the entire value proposition.

Partnership model: CE provider approval co-sponsorship

What DUG offers them

- **Enrollment driver** DUG sends California licensees to IEA for CE courses they cannot get elsewhere — incremental enrollment for IEA.
- **Content partnership** DUG Dojo cases that align with California CE requirements can be co-branded with IEA, giving them a digital practice product they don't currently have.
- **Platform visibility** IEA is featured as DUG's CE partner on the platform — visible to every California member.

What DUG asks for

- **CE approval pathway** IEA's guidance and co-sponsorship support for DUG's California CE provider application.
- **Content review** IEA reviews a sample set of Dojo cases for CE credit eligibility, identifying which hours they would apply toward.
- **Member feature** One IEA member communication featuring DUG as a practice and income resource.

Initial outreach email

Subject: CE provider co-sponsorship inquiry — DUG Dojo case completions

Hi [Name],

I'm reaching out from DUG — Decentralized Underwriting Group. We operate a practice platform called the Dojo where licensed underwriters, agents, and brokers work through curated risk cases and receive scored feedback.

We're pursuing CE provider approval in California and would welcome a conversation about whether IEA would be willing to co-sponsor or review our application. Our Dojo

cases are built around real underwriting scenarios and we believe a meaningful portion qualify for CE credit under California's existing curriculum guidelines.

In return, we'd feature IEA as a recommended CE partner for all California DUG members and drive enrollment to your courses for hours outside our scope.

Would you have 20 minutes to review a sample case set and discuss next steps?

[Your name]

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PLUS — Professional Liability Underwriting Society

Contest sponsorship + conference presence. The right 500 people in one room.

Target audience: Professional liability underwriters — D&O, E&O, cyber, management liability

Outreach priority: 3 — High-value niche. Approach after initial traction with Institutes and National Alliance.

Partnership model: Dojo contest sponsorship + PLUS annual conference presence

What DUG offers them

- **Contest sponsorship** PLUS sponsors a named DUG Dojo contest in professional liability lines — their brand on the leaderboard, prizes for top performers, research data on current PL underwriting patterns across the community.
- **Conference content** DUG presents Dojo performance data at the PLUS annual conference — what the community sees as the hardest PL risk scenarios, how scores distribute, where judgment gaps exist.
- **Community bridge** DUG's PL community discussions drive ongoing engagement with PLUS themes and issues between annual events.

What DUG asks for

- **Contest sponsorship fee** PLUS sponsors an annual Dojo contest in their lines — covering prize pool and featured placement.
- **Conference slot** A 20-minute session or panel slot at the PLUS annual conference.
- **Member outreach** One PLUS member communication promoting DUG as a practice and income resource for PL specialists.

Initial outreach email

Subject: Dojo contest sponsorship + conference session — PLUS x DUG

Hi [Name],

I'm reaching out from DUG — Decentralized Underwriting Group. We run a practice platform called the Dojo where underwriters work scored case scenarios. We're building a professional liability track and are looking for a founding sponsor.

A PLUS-sponsored Dojo contest would put your brand in front of active PL underwriters

doing real practice work – not just reading a newsletter. Winners get recognition and prize money; PLUS gets anonymized data on how PL judgment is actually distributed across the current market.

We'd also welcome a session slot at your annual conference to share Dojo findings – what the community finds hardest, where scores cluster, what that says about the current PL talent landscape.

Worth a conversation?

[Your name]

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RIMS — Risk and Insurance Management Society

Member benefit pitch. DUG as a resource for risk managers, not a competitor to anyone.

Target audience: Corporate risk managers — DUG's professional-tier requester base

Outreach priority: 3 — Different audience than the others. Approach as a requester acquisition channel, not underwriter pipeline.

Partnership model: Member benefit feature — DUG promoted as a pre-renewal advisory resource for RIMS members

What DUG offers them

- **Member benefit** RIMS members get a pre-renewal consulting resource they don't have anywhere else — independent underwriter analysis before their broker meeting, at professional-tier pricing.
- **Chapter content** DUG provides case-based content for RIMS chapter meetings — what independent underwriters see in renewal data, how to read a market shift, when to push back on your broker.
- **Research partnership** DUG's Dojo performance data can inform RIMS research on how underwriting judgment patterns affect risk manager renewal outcomes.

What DUG asks for

- **Member communication** RIMS chapter and national newsletters feature DUG as a recommended pre-renewal resource.
- **Chapter event access** DUG presents at 2–3 RIMS chapter events in year one.
- **RIMS Annual presence** DUG exhibit or speaking slot at RIMS Annual Conference & Exhibition.

Initial outreach email

Subject: Member benefit inquiry — independent pre-renewal advisory for RIMS members

Hi [Name],

I'm reaching out from DUG — Decentralized Underwriting Group. We're a platform where anyone can hire an independent credentialed underwriter for advisory analysis — second opinions on renewals, pre-broker consults, coverage dispute reviews.

For risk managers, we think DUG solves a real problem: walking into a renewal

negotiation without knowing whether your carrier's pricing is defensible. An independent underwriter's opinion – at a flat fee, delivered in 48 hours – changes that dynamic.

We'd like to explore featuring DUG as a member benefit for RIMS members, starting with a chapter-level pilot. No exclusivity required – we're simply a tool your members don't currently know they have access to.

Would you be open to a brief call to explore what that looks like?

[Your name]

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Embedded E&O: The Long-Term Partnership Layer

The most durable partnership DUG can build with certification organizations is not about logos or event presence — it is about E&O insurance.

The Institutes and the National Alliance both maintain relationships with E&O carriers through their group programs for members. As DUG grows its credentialed marketplace underwriter base, the opportunity is to negotiate a group E&O master policy through one of those existing relationships — underwriters join DUG's marketplace, DUG facilitates their E&O coverage, and the certification org is the distribution channel.

Stage	Action
Year 1	Establish partnership with The Institutes or National Alliance — credential verification focus
Year 1–2	Achieve CE provider status in 2–3 states — drives underwriter adoption
Year 2	Negotiate group E&O master policy through partner org's existing carrier relationships
Year 2–3	DUG facilitates E&O for marketplace underwriters at point of onboarding — embedded premium revenue
Year 3+	Scale E&O program as marketplace grows — revenue share with partner org

Why this matters for outreach conversations

When approaching The Institutes or the National Alliance, mentioning the E&O program as a long-term goal — not a year-one ask — signals that DUG is thinking about a durable institutional relationship, not a marketing arrangement. It also gives those organizations a financial stake in DUG's growth that goes beyond logo placement.

Recommended Next Steps

Execute in this order to build momentum without spreading outreach thin:

- **Week 1–2:** Identify the right contacts at The Institutes (VP of Products or Director of Member Engagement) and IEA (Executive Director). LinkedIn is reliable for both.
- **Week 2–3:** Send outreach emails to The Institutes and IEA concurrently. These are the two conversations with the highest near-term leverage — verification credibility and CE credit approval.

- **Week 3–4:** If initial responses are positive, schedule introductory calls. Come prepared with a one-page DUG overview and the specific ask (verification API partnership / CE co-sponsorship).
- **Month 2:** Approach the National Alliance once The Institutes conversation has traction — being able to say 'we're already in discussions with The Institutes on verification' strengthens the pitch.
- **Month 3+:** Approach PLUS and RIMS after first partnerships are formalized. Having 1–2 institutional partners in place makes the sponsor and member-benefit conversations significantly easier.

Questions about this framework:

hello@dug.community